

“Can you meet?” or “Please call me”. With devices now able to reply, and with the ability to send an email from a computer to someone travelling on the road, two-way paging and on-the-go email access became hot; very hot.

BlackBerry came into the picture with their first device called the RIM 850. This device had a QWERTY keypad, an OS that gave you access to email on the go, had a monochrome screen, and could even do some very basic HTML browsing. The device was called a BlackBerry later, presumably because the keys were shaped like the drupelets of the blackberry fruit. It received push email from a Microsoft Exchange Server by using the very first implementation of BES (BlackBerry Enterprise Server). This beginning is also pretty telling why RIM has always been so focussed on email as their speciality.



RIM / BlackBerry 850

Popularity

RIM / BlackBerry kept email at the centre of their ethos, and started adding layers of security that governments and enterprise customers wanted. High-grade encryption of emails being sent through the RIM servers meant that people were more secure knowing that their emails had been sent to the correct recipient, and would not get snooped on along the way.

In 2002, BlackBerry released their first phone-cum-messaging device – the BlackBerry 5810. It was still mostly a messaging device, and had no speaker /



BlackBerry 5810